Robust, garlicky, and fragrant with rosemary and sage, this is a hearty, satisfying soup. Serve it with some fresh crusty bread and a drizzle of good-quality olive oil.

bean and rosemary soup

SERVES 8 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

2 tbsp olive oil
2 onions, finely chopped
salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 tbsp finely chopped fresh rosemary leaves
a few fresh sage leaves, finely chopped
4 celery ribs, finely chopped
3 garlic cloves, grated or finely chopped
2 tbsp tomato purée
2 x 14oz (400g) cans borlotti beans, drained, rinsed, and drained again
1¼ quarts (1¼ liters) hot chicken stock
5½lb (2.5kg) potatoes, cut into chunky pieces

1 Heat the oil in a large pan, add the onions, and cook over low heat for 6–8 minutes or until soft and translucent. Season well with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then stir in the rosemary, sage, celery, and garlic and cook over very low heat, stirring occasionally, for 10 minutes.

2 Stir in the tomato purée and beans and cook gently for 5 minutes. Pour in the stock, bring to a boil, then add the potatoes and simmer gently for 15 minutes or until cooked. Taste, season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, if needed, and serve.